

From Order Automation to Revenue Retention

Choco - AI Product Discovery & Product Teardown

How might food-distributor sales teams spot revenue at risk early enough to act - and when does AI actually add value?

CHOCO

REVENUE
SIGNALS

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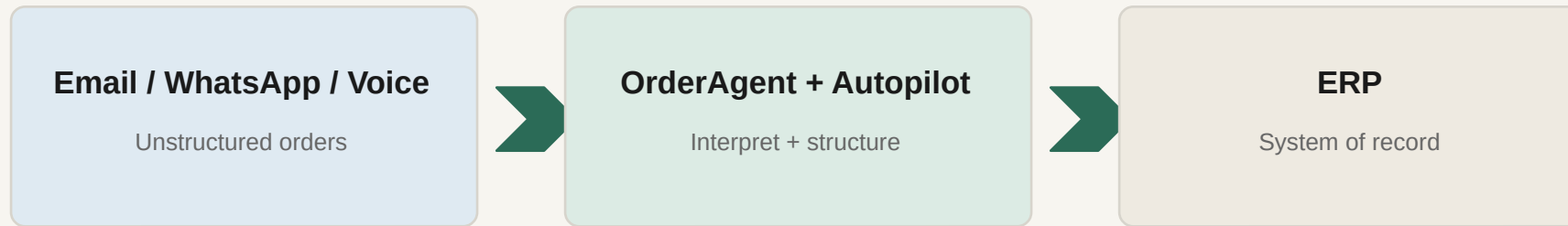
AI Product Management Portfolio

Independent concept - not affiliated with Choco

The opportunity changed as the product evolved

My original discovery question now overlaps with Choco's live CustomerHub - so I reframe it as a product teardown + extension hypothesis.

CHoco today



Portfolio reframing

Instead of “Should Choco build churn intelligence?”, the sharper question becomes:

How might Choco make customer-risk signals more trustworthy, actionable, and measurably tied to retained revenue?

REALITY CHECK

CustomerHub already offers:

- early churn signals
- dropped-SKU detection
- customer health visibility
- follow-up tasks & actions

Who actually has the problem?

In B2B, user, manager, buyer, and beneficiary are not the same person.

PRIMARY USER

Sales rep / Account manager

Manages 150-300 restaurant accounts and decides where to spend attention.

SECONDARY USER

Sales manager

Needs visibility into portfolio risk, rep follow-up, and account recovery.

BUYER

Head of Sales / Commercial Lead

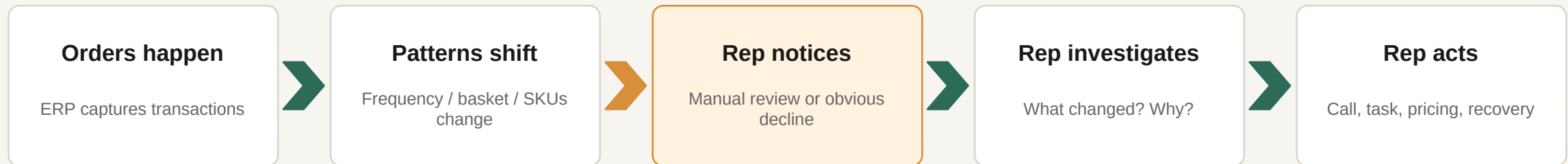
Cares about retention, margin, sales productivity, and predictable growth.

JOB TO BE DONE

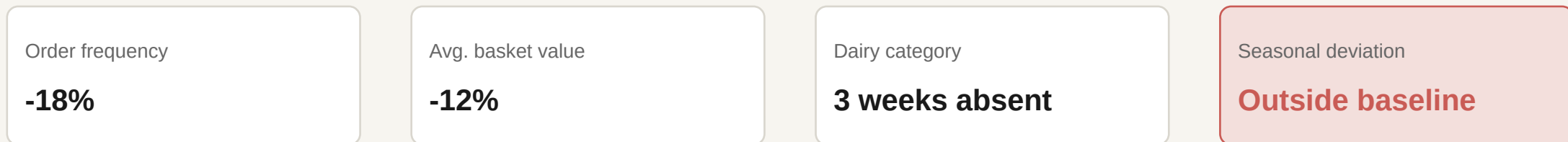
“When I manage a large portfolio of restaurant customers, I want to understand which accounts require my attention and why, so that I can take the right action before meaningful revenue is lost.”

The data exists. The signal may still arrive too late.

The core hypothesis is not “we lack data” - it is “weak signals are hard to interpret and prioritize across a large portfolio.”



Weak signals can accumulate before decline becomes obvious



Problem hypothesis: the signal is not visible early enough, clearly enough, or in a way that reliably leads to action.

Facts vs. assumptions

A discovery case is only credible when it separates public evidence from what still needs validation.

SUPPORTED OBSERVATIONS

- Choco structures order data and integrates it with ERP workflows.
- CustomerHub already surfaces ordering trends and early churn signals.
- CustomerHub highlights dropped SKUs and follow-up activity.
- Choco combines predictive ML, LLM components, confidence checks, and human feedback.

ASSUMPTIONS TO VALIDATE

- Reps still notice some material account decline too late.
- Earlier signals change rep behavior - not just awareness.
- Reps have enough capacity to act on additional signals.
- Better prioritization and explanation materially improve retained revenue.

Riskiest assumption: earlier signals actually lead to timely actions that recover meaningful revenue.

Validate the behavior before the model

The first question is not “Can we predict risk?” It is “Would earlier, evidence-backed signals change what reps do?”

Interview the workflow, not the idea

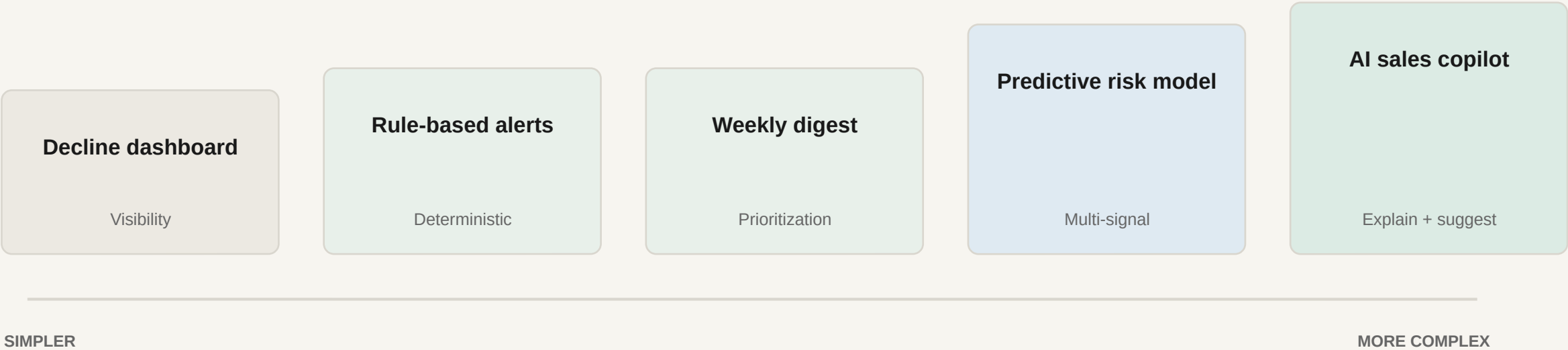
- 1 Tell me about the last important account that declined.
- 2 How did you notice - and how long had it been happening?
- 3 What information did you need before contacting them?
- 4 How do you distinguish seasonality from genuine risk?
- 5 What workaround do you use today - CRM, Excel, memory, reports?

What I would look for

- Frequency** Does this happen often enough?
- Severity** Is meaningful revenue really at risk?
- Behavior** Do reps change what they do?
- Workaround** Are they already investing effort?
- Business impact** Can action plausibly recover value?

AI should earn its place

Start with the cheapest mechanism that can create the user outcome. Escalate complexity only when the problem demands it.



Decision gate

If a simple threshold solves most of the value, stop there. Use predictive ML only when multiple interacting signals materially improve prioritization - and use an LLM only when explanation or next-step support adds user value.

Account Pulse - evidence-backed prioritization

A clickable concept focused on trust and actionability, not autonomous selling.

Account Pulse

Revenue risk workspace

High-risk accounts

12

Revenue at risk

€184k

Actioned this week

19

Avg. time to action

1.8d

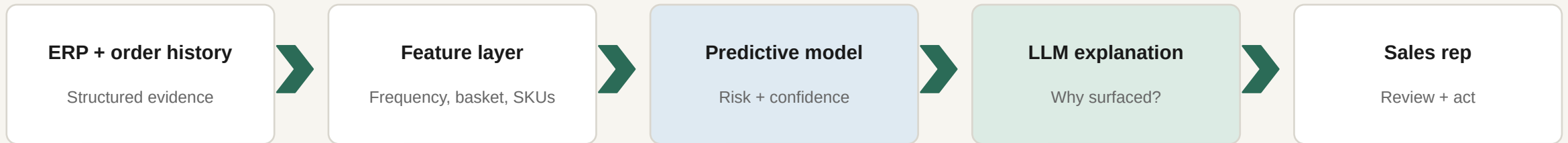
Accounts needing attention

	Risk	Revenue at risk	Why now?	Next action
Bella Napoli	High	€7.2k	Dairy absent 3 wks	Review account
Mitte Bistro	High	€12.4k	Spend -31% vs baseline	Contact owner
Green Fork	Medium	€4.1k	Order frequency -18%	Check seasonality

View evidence → human decides

Use AI for the parts where it adds leverage

Keep observed facts, model interpretation, and human action explicitly separate.



Human-in-the-loop rule: AI may surface, explain, and recommend - but pricing, outreach, and commercial decisions remain human-controlled.

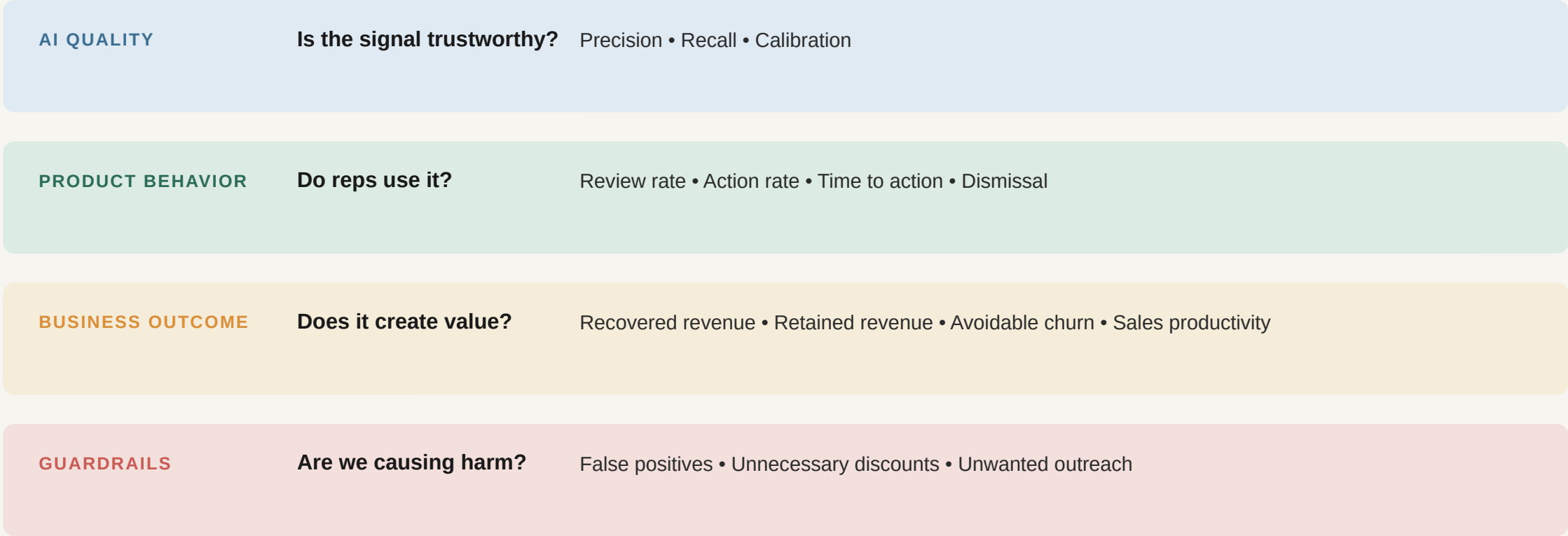
WIZARD-OF-OZ TEST BEFORE BUILDING A MODEL

- 1 Use historical account data
- 2 Manually surface 5-10 evidence-backed risk cards
- 3 Ask reps: relevant? actionable? missing context?
- 4 Measure whether the signal changes behavior

Pass signal: reps repeatedly say “I would have wanted to know this earlier” AND can name a clear next action.

Model performance is only the first gate

The product creates value only when a good signal becomes a timely action and a measurable business outcome.



Prediction → Understanding → Decision → Action → Business outcome

If action rate is low, a better model may not be the answer.

Validate behavior first. Build intelligence second.

The strongest uncertainty is behavioral and commercial, not technical feasibility.

RECOMMENDATION

Test whether earlier, evidence-backed account signals change sales behavior enough to protect revenue.

Only after that should the team invest in more sophisticated prediction, explanation, or automation.

PM principle AI should earn its place by creating a better user or business outcome than a simpler solution.

What this case demonstrates

- Problem framing before solutioning
- B2B user / buyer separation
- Facts vs. assumptions discipline
- AI vs. deterministic trade-offs
- Human-in-the-loop product design
- Experiment + metrics thinking

Independent portfolio case study. Not affiliated with Choco.

PUBLIC SOURCES

[1] Choco CustomerHub [2] Choco SalesHub [3] Choco OrderAgent / Autopilot [4] "What Makes Choco's AI So Good?" (Choco)